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一、中英文主旨

中文主旨

本文通过乔治·华盛顿移植奴隶牙齿的鲜为人知的史实，颠覆了大众对美国开国元勋的传统印象，引出历史学家对奴隶制在美国开国一代生活中所起作用的深入研究。文章指出，尽管多数开国元勋私下认为奴隶制是错误的，但受时代文化、南方经济基础和自身政治利益的三重束缚，他们大多未能积极推动废奴，同时也客观提及了华盛顿和杰斐逊晚年在解放奴隶问题上做出的有限且矛盾的努力。

英文主旨

This article subverts the public's traditional impression of the Founding Fathers of the United States through the little-known historical fact that George Washington transplanted teeth from his slaves, and leads to the in-depth research of historians on the role of slavery in the lives of the founding generation. It points out that although most Founding Fathers privately believed that slavery was wrong, most of them failed to actively promote the abolition of slavery due to the triple constraints of the culture of their time, the southern economic foundation and their own political interests. It also objectively mentions the limited and contradictory efforts made by Washington and Jefferson to free slaves in their later years.

二、逐句翻译+常考单词短语+长难句分析

第一段

1. **原文**: In 1784, five years before he became president of the United States, George Washington, 52, was nearly toothless.

翻译: 1784年，也就是乔治·华盛顿成为美国总统的五年前，52岁的他几乎没有牙齿了。

常考单词/短语:

- president /'prezɪdənt/ n. 总统；董事长；校长
- nearly /'ni:əli/ adv. 几乎，差不多
- toothless /'tu:θləs/ adj. 无齿的；软弱无力的

2. **原文**: So he hired a dentist to transplant nine teeth into his jaw — having extracted them from the mouths of his slaves.

翻译: 于是他雇了一位牙医，将九颗牙齿移植到自己的颌骨上——这些牙齿是从他的奴隶们嘴里拔下来的。

常考单词/短语:

- hire /'haɪə(r)/ v. 雇用；租用 n. 雇用；租金
- dentist /'dentɪst/ n. 牙医
- transplant /træns'plɑ:nt/ v. 移植；移栽 /'trænsplɑ:nt/ n. 移植
- jaw /dʒɔ:/ n. 颌；下巴；下颌
- extract /ɪk'strækt/ v. 提取；拔出；摘录 /'ekstrækt/ n. 提取物；摘录
- slave /sleɪv/ n. 奴隶；从动装置 v. 苦干；拼命干

第二段

1. **原文:** That's a far different image from the cherry-tree-chopping George most people remember from their history books.

翻译: 这与大多数人从历史课本中记住的那个砍樱桃树的乔治形象大相径庭。

常考单词/短语:

- far different from 与.....大相径庭
- image /'ɪmɪdʒ/ n. 形象; 图像; 影像
- cherry /'tʃeri/ n. 樱桃; 樱桃树
- chop /tʃɒp/ v. 砍; 劈; 剁碎 n. 砍; 排骨
- remember /rɪ'membə(r)/ v. 记得; 记住; 纪念

2. **原文:** But recently, many historians have begun to focus on the role slavery played in the lives of the founding generation.

翻译: 但最近, 许多历史学家开始关注奴隶制在开国元勋那一代人的生活中所扮演的角色。

常考单词/短语:

- historian /hɪ'stɔ:riən/ n. 历史学家
- focus on 关注; 集中于
- role /rəʊl/ n. 角色; 作用
- slavery /'sleɪvəri/ n. 奴隶制; 奴隶身份
- founding generation 开国一代; 开国元勋

3. **原文:** They have been spurred in part by DNA evidence made available in 1998, which almost certainly proved Thomas Jefferson had fathered at least one child with his slave Sally Hemings.

翻译: 1998年公开的DNA证据在一定程度上推动了他们的研究, 该证据几乎可以肯定地证明, 托马斯·杰斐逊与他的奴隶萨莉·海明斯至少育有一个孩子。

长难句分析:

- 主句: They have been spurred in part by DNA evidence (被动语态, 强调动作的承受者)
- 后置定语: made available in 1998 (过去分词短语, 修饰 evidence)
- 非限制性定语从句: which almost certainly proved... (修饰 evidence, 补充说明证据的内容)
- 宾语从句: Thomas Jefferson had fathered at least one child with his slave Sally Hemings (作 proved 的宾语)

常考单词/短语:

- spur /spɜ:(r)/ v. 激励; 鞭策; 促进 n. 马刺; 激励因素
- in part 部分地; 在某种程度上
- evidence /'eɪdəns/ n. 证据; 证明; 迹象
- available /ə'veɪləbl/ adj. 可获得的; 可利用的; 有空的
- almost /'ɔ:lməʊst/ adv. 几乎, 差不多
- certainly /'sɜ:tnli/ adv. 当然; 肯定; 无疑
- prove /pru:v/ v. 证明; 证实; 显示出
- father /'fɑ:ðə(r)/ v. 成为.....的父亲; 创立 n. 父亲; 创始人
- at least 至少

4. **原文:** And only over the past 30 years have scholars examined history from the bottom up.

翻译: 而且, 学者们只是在过去30年里才开始自下而上地审视历史。

长难句分析:

- 部分倒装句: only + 时间状语(over the past 30 years) 置于句首, 主句需将助动词 have 提前
- 正常语序: And scholars have examined history from the bottom up only over the past 30 years

常考单词/短语:

- scholar /'skɒlə(r)/ n. 学者; 奖学金获得者
- examine /ɪg'zæmɪn/ v. 检查; 审查; 调查; 考试
- from the bottom up 自下而上; 彻底地

5. **原文:** Works of several historians reveal the moral compromises made by the nation's early leaders and the fragile nature of the country's infancy.

翻译: 几位历史学家的著作揭示了这个国家早期领导人所做出的道德妥协, 以及这个国家在初创时期的脆弱本质。

常考单词/短语:

- work /wɜ:k/ n. 著作; 作品; 工作 v. 工作; 运转
- reveal /rɪ'veɪl/ v. 揭示; 透露; 显示
- moral /'mɒrəl/ adj. 道德的; 精神上的 n. 道德; 寓意
- compromise /'kɒmprəmaɪz/ n. 妥协; 折中 v. 妥协; 折中; 危及
- fragile /'frædʒaɪl/ adj. 脆弱的; 易碎的; 虚弱的
- nature /'neɪtʃə(r)/ n. 本质; 性质; 自然
- infancy /'ɪnfənsi/ n. 初期; 婴儿期

6. **原文:** More significantly, they argue that many of the Founding Fathers knew slavery was wrong and yet most did little to fight it.

翻译: 更重要的是, 他们认为, 许多开国元勋都知道奴隶制是错误的, 但大多数人却几乎没有采取任何行动去反对它。

长难句分析:

- 主句: they argue that...
- 宾语从句: that many of the Founding Fathers knew slavery was wrong and yet most did little to fight it (由 and yet 连接两个并列分句)
- 嵌套宾语从句: slavery was wrong (作第一个分句中 knew 的宾语)

常考单词/短语:

- significantly /sɪg'nɪfɪkəntli/ adv. 显著地; 重要地
- argue /'ɑ:gju:/ v. 认为; 争论; 辩论; 主张
- Founding Fathers 开国元勋 (特指美国)
- wrong /rɒŋ/ adj. 错误的; 不对的; 不道德的 adv. 错误地
- yet /jet/ conj. 然而; 但是 adv. 还; 仍然
- fight /faɪt/ v. 战斗; 斗争; 反对 n. 战斗; 斗争

第三段

1. **原文:** More than anything, the historians say, the founders were hampered by the culture of their time.

翻译: 历史学家们说, 最重要的是, 这些开国元勋们受到了他们那个时代文化的束缚。

常考单词/短语:

- more than anything 最重要的是; 尤其
- hamper /'hæmpə(r)/ v. 妨碍; 束缚; 阻碍 n. 篮子; 障碍物
- culture /'kʌltʃə(r)/ n. 文化; 文明; 培养

2. **原文:** While Washington and Jefferson privately expressed distaste for slavery, they also understood that it was part of the political and economic bedrock of the country they helped to create.

翻译: 尽管华盛顿和杰斐逊私下里都表达了对奴隶制的厌恶, 但他们也明白, 奴隶制是他们帮助建立的这个国家的政治和经济基石的一部分。

长难句分析:

- 让步状语从句: while Washington and Jefferson privately expressed distaste for slavery (while 引导, 表转折)
- 主句: they also understood that...

- 宾语从句: **that it was part of the political and economic bedrock of the country**
- 定语从句: **they helped to create** (修饰 **the country**, 省略了关系代词 **which/that**)

常考单词/短语:

- while /waɪl/ conj. 虽然; 尽管; 当.....的时候
- privately /'praɪvətli/ adv. 私下地; 秘密地
- express /ɪk'spres/ v. 表达; 表示; 传递 n. 快车; 快递
- distaste /dɪs'teɪst/ n. 厌恶; 讨厌 v. 厌恶; 不喜欢
- distaste for 对.....的厌恶
- political /pə'lɪtɪkl/ adj. 政治的; 政党的
- economic /,i:kə'nɒmɪk/ adj. 经济的; 经济学的
- bedrock /'bedrɒk/ n. 基石; 基础; 根底
- create /kri'eɪt/ v. 创造; 创建; 造成

第四段

1. **原文:** For one thing, the South could not afford to part with its slaves.

翻译: 一方面, 南方承担不起失去奴隶的代价。

常考单词/短语:

- for one thing 一方面; 首先
- afford /ə'fɔ:d/ v. 买得起; 承担得起; 提供
- afford to do sth. 承担得起做某事
- part with 放弃; 失去; 卖掉

2. **原文:** Owning slaves was "like having a large bank account," says Wiencek, author of *An Imperfect God: George Washington, His Slaves, and the Creation of America*.

翻译: 拥有奴隶“就像拥有一个巨额银行账户”, 《不完美的上帝: 乔治·华盛顿、他的奴隶与美国的创建》一书的作者温塞克说道。

常考单词/短语:

- own /əʊn/ v. 拥有; 承认 adj. 自己的; 特有的
- account /ə'kaʊnt/ n. 账户; 账目; 解释 v. 解释; 导致
- bank account 银行账户
- author /'ɔ:θə(r)/ n. 作者; 作家; 创始人
- creation /kri'eɪʃn/ n. 创建; 创造; 作品

3. **原文:** The southern states would not have signed the Constitution without protections for the "peculiar institution," including a clause that counted a slave as three fifths of a man for purposes of congressional representation.

翻译: 如果没有对这种“特殊制度”的保护条款, 南方各州是不会签署宪法的, 其中包括一项条款, 规定在计算国会代表名额时, 一个奴隶按五分之三个白人计算。

长难句分析:

- 含蓄虚拟语气: **would not have signed** 表示与过去事实相反的假设, **without** 引导含蓄条件句 (相当于 **if there had been no protections...**)
- 后置定语: **including a clause...** (现在分词短语, 补充说明 **protections** 的内容)
- 定语从句: **that counted a slave as three fifths of a man for purposes of congressional representation** (修饰 **a clause**)

常考单词/短语:

- southern /'sʌðən/ adj. 南方的; 南部的
- sign /saɪn/ v. 签署; 签名; 示意 n. 迹象; 符号; 手势
- constitution /,kɒnstɪ'tju:ʃn/ n. 宪法; 章程; 体质
- protection /prə'tekʃn/ n. 保护; 防卫; 保护物
- peculiar /prɪ'kju:liə(r)/ adj. 特殊的; 独特的; 奇怪的

- institution /ˌɪnstɪ'tjuːʃn/ n. 制度；机构；创立
- clause /klaʊz/ n. 条款；从句
- count...as... 把.....算作.....
- purpose /'pɜ:pəs/ n. 目的；用途；意志
- for purposes of 为了.....的目的
- congressional /kən'ɡrefənəl/ adj. 国会的；议会的
- representation /ˌreprɪzen'teɪʃn/ n. 代表；代表权；表现

第五段

1. **原文**: And the statesmen's political lives depended on slavery.

翻译: 而且，这些政治家的政治生涯也依赖于奴隶制。

常考单词/短语:

- statesman /'steɪtsmən/ n. 政治家；国务活动家
- depend on 依赖；依靠；取决于
- political life 政治生涯

2. **原文**: The three-fifths formula handed Jefferson his narrow victory in the presidential election of 1800 by inflating the votes of the southern states in the Electoral College.

翻译: 五分之三条款通过增加选举人团中南方各州的票数，使杰斐逊在1800年的总统选举中以微弱优势获胜。

常考单词/短语:

- formula /'fɔ:mjələ/ n. 公式；准则；方案
- hand /hænd/ v. 传递；交给；支持 n. 手；帮助
- narrow /'nærəʊ/ adj. 狭窄的；勉强的；有限的
- victory /'vɪktəri/ n. 胜利；成功
- presidential /ˌprezɪ'denʃl/ adj. 总统的；总统选举的
- election /ɪ'lekʃn/ n. 选举；当选；选择权
- inflate /ɪn'fleɪt/ v. 使膨胀；抬高；夸大
- vote /vəʊt/ n. 选票；投票；选举 v. 投票；选举
- Electoral College (美国) 选举人团

3. **原文**: Once in office, Jefferson extended slavery with the Louisiana Purchase in 1803; the new land was carved into 13 states, including three slave states.

翻译: 杰斐逊上任后，于1803年通过路易斯安那购地案扩大了奴隶制的范围；这片新土地被划分为13个州，其中包括3个蓄奴州。

常考单词/短语:

- once in office 上任后；就职后
- extend /ɪk'stend/ v. 扩大；延伸；延长；推广
- purchase /'pɜ:tʃəs/ n. 购买；购置物 v. 购买；购置
- Louisiana Purchase 路易斯安那购地案
- carve /kɑ:v/ v. 雕刻；切开；开创
- carve into 把.....切成/分成.....
- slave state 蓄奴州

第六段

1. **原文**: Still, Jefferson freed Hemings's children — though not Hemings herself or his approximately 150 other slaves.

翻译: 尽管如此，杰斐逊还是解放了海明斯的孩子——不过没有解放海明斯本人，也没有解放他其他大约150名奴隶。

常考单词/短语:

- still /stɪl/ adv. 仍然；尽管如此；还是

- free /fri:/ v. 解放；释放；使自由 adj. 自由的；免费的
- though /ðəʊ/ conj. 虽然；尽管；不过
- approximately /ə'prɒksɪmətli/ adv. 大约；近似地

2. **原文**：Washington, who had begun to believe that all men were created equal after observing the bravery of the black soldiers during the Revolutionary War, overcame the strong opposition of his relatives to grant his slaves their freedom in his will.

翻译：华盛顿在独立战争期间目睹了黑人士兵的英勇表现后，开始相信人人生而平等，他不顾亲属们的强烈反对，在遗嘱中赋予了他的奴隶们自由。

长难句分析：

- 主句：Washington overcame the strong opposition of his relatives to grant his slaves their freedom in his will (不定式 to grant... 作目的状语)
- 非限制性定语从句：who had begun to believe that all men were created equal... (修饰 Washington)
- 宾语从句：that all men were created equal (作 believe 的宾语)
- 时间状语：after observing the bravery of the black soldiers during the Revolutionary War (介词短语)

常考单词/短语：

- create equal 生而平等
- observe /əb'zɜ:v/ v. 观察；注意到；遵守；庆祝
- bravery /'breɪvəri/ n. 勇敢；勇气
- black /blæk/ adj. 黑色的；黑人的 n. 黑人；黑色
- soldier /'səʊldʒə(r)/ n. 士兵；军人
- Revolutionary War (美国) 独立战争
- overcome /,əʊvə'kʌm/ v. 克服；战胜；压倒
- strong /strɒŋ/ adj. 强烈的；强壮的；坚强的
- opposition /,ɒpə'zɪʃn/ n. 反对；反对派；对立
- relative /'relətɪv/ n. 亲属；亲戚 adj. 相对的；有关系的
- grant /grɑ:nt/ v. 授予；给予；承认 n. 补助金；拨款
- freedom /'fri:dəm/ n. 自由；自主；免除
- will /wɪl/ n. 遗嘱；意志；决心 v. 将要；愿意

3. **原文**：Only a decade earlier, such an act would have required legislative approval in Virginia.

翻译：仅仅十年前，这样的举动在弗吉尼亚州还需要得到立法机构的批准。

常考单词/短语：

- decade /'dekeɪd/ n. 十年，十年期
- act /ækt/ n. 行为；行动；法令 v. 行动；扮演；起作用
- require /rɪ'kwaɪə(r)/ v. 需要；要求；命令
- legislative /'ledʒɪslətɪv/ adj. 立法的；有立法权的
- approval /ə'pru:vəl/ n. 批准；认可；赞成

三、完整文章原文

In 1784, five years before he became president of the United States, George Washington, 52, was nearly toothless. So he hired a dentist to transplant nine teeth into his jaw — having extracted them from the mouths of his slaves.

That's a far different image from the cherry-tree-chopping George most people remember from their history books. But recently, many historians have begun to focus on the role slavery played in the lives of the founding generation. They have been spurred in part by DNA evidence made available in 1998, which almost certainly proved Thomas Jefferson had fathered at least one child with his slave Sally Hemings. And only over the past 30 years have scholars examined history from the bottom up. Works of several historians reveal the moral compromises made by the nation's early leaders and the fragile nature of the country's infancy. More significantly, they

argue that many of the Founding Fathers knew slavery was wrong and yet most did little to fight it.

More than anything, the historians say, the founders were hampered by the culture of their time. While Washington and Jefferson privately expressed distaste for slavery, they also understood that it was part of the political and economic bedrock of the country they helped to create.

For one thing, the South could not afford to part with its slaves. Owning slaves was "like having a large bank account," says Wiencek, author of *An Imperfect God: George Washington, His Slaves, and the Creation of America*. The southern states would not have signed the Constitution without protections for the "peculiar institution," including a clause that counted a slave as three fifths of a man for purposes of congressional representation.

And the statesmen's political lives depended on slavery. The three-fifths formula handed Jefferson his narrow victory in the presidential election of 1800 by inflating the votes of the southern states in the Electoral College. Once in office, Jefferson extended slavery with the Louisiana Purchase in 1803; the new land was carved into 13 states, including three slave states.

Still, Jefferson freed Hemings's children — though not Hemings herself or his approximately 150 other slaves. Washington, who had begun to believe that all men were created equal after observing the bravery of the black soldiers during the Revolutionary War, overcame the strong opposition of his relatives to grant his slaves their freedom in his will. Only a decade earlier, such an act would have required legislative approval in Virginia.

四、完整文章翻译

1784年，也就是乔治·华盛顿成为美国总统的五年前，52岁的他几乎没有牙齿了。于是他雇了一位牙医，将九颗牙齿移植到自己的颌骨上——这些牙齿是从他的奴隶们嘴里拔下来的。

这与大多数人从历史课本中记住的那个砍樱桃树的乔治形象大相径庭。但最近，许多历史学家开始关注奴隶制在开国元勋那一代人的生活中所扮演的角色。1998年公开的DNA证据在一定程度上推动了他们的研究，该证据几乎可以肯定地证明，托马斯·杰斐逊与他的奴隶萨莉·海明斯至少育有一个孩子。而且，学者们只是在过去30年里才开始自下而上地审视历史。几位历史学家的著作揭示了个国家早期领导人所做出的道德妥协，以及这个国家在初创时期的脆弱本质。更重要的是，他们认为，许多开国元勋都知道奴隶制是错误的，但大多数人却几乎没有采取任何行动去反对它。

历史学家们说，最重要的是，这些开国元勋们受到了他们那个时代文化的束缚。尽管华盛顿和杰斐逊私下里都表达了对奴隶制的厌恶，但他们也明白，奴隶制是他们帮助建立的这个国家的政治和经济基石的一部分。

一方面，南方承担不起失去奴隶的代价。拥有奴隶“就像拥有一个巨额银行账户”，《不完美的上帝：乔治·华盛顿、他的奴隶与美国的创建》一书的作者温塞克说道。如果没有对这种“特殊制度”的保护条款，南方各州是不会签署宪法的，其中包括一项条款，规定在计算国会代表名额时，一个奴隶按五分之三个白人计算。

而且，这些政治家的政治生涯也依赖于奴隶制。五分之三条款通过增加选举人团中南方各州的票数，使杰斐逊在1800年的总统选举中以微弱优势获胜。杰斐逊上任后，于1803年通过路易斯安那购地案扩大了奴隶制的范围；这片新土地被划分为13个州，其中包括3个蓄奴州。

尽管如此，杰斐逊还是解放了海明斯的孩子——不过没有解放海明斯本人，也没有解放他其他大约150名奴隶。华盛顿在独立战争期间目睹了黑人士兵的英勇表现后，开始相信人人生而平等，他不顾亲属们的强烈反对，在遗嘱中赋予了他的奴隶们自由。仅仅十年前，这样的举动在弗吉尼亚州还需要得到立法机构的批准。

